

CAREER PATHS

There are two main ways to become a store manager: by joining a company as a sales assistant and gaining promotion through merit, or joining a retailer's training program, which may be open to part-time students or graduates. The prospects for progression are good, with vacancies at retailers of all sizes and specializations.

TRAINEE You can join a retailer as a sales assistant and work your way up, or enroll in the company's management training program.

GRADUATE A degree in any discipline will enable you to join a graduate training program, but employers favor subjects such as business studies, retail management, and marketing.



STORE MANAGER After gaining experience, you can seek promotion to work in a larger branch, or in one of the business areas of retailing, such as buying, human resources, or marketing.



RETAIL IT MANAGER
Responsible for a store's technology systems—such as point-of-sale, stock ordering, and cash accounting—IT managers install updates and resolve computer problems as and when they occur.



HUMAN RESOURCES (HR) MANAGER
Deals with staffing issues for a large store or for a number of stores, organizing recruitment, training, payroll, and staff rotations.



OPERATIONS MANAGER
Works with store managers and regional managers to help a business to increase its profits through methods such as marketing, more efficient stock control, or improved customer service.



REGIONAL MANAGER Takes responsibility for the retail activities and profitability of a number of stores in a certain area, and liaises with senior management.

SKILLS GUIDE



The ability to communicate well with customers and staff while maintaining a calm disposition.



Excellent team-working skills for motivating staff to achieve a store's sales targets.



Creativity and innovation in sales techniques and product display to increase store revenues.



Strong leadership skills to inspire staff to reach their potential and deliver excellent service.



Business-management skills, commercial awareness, and the ability to spot future trends.